10-08 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle Schools Allow Students to Choose Some of Their Own Elective Classes?

① Last month our school released a new timetable. Four hours every week, from Grade 7 to Grade 9, are now labelled simply **"Elective Class"**. Students can choose from a list of 16 subjects: drama, robotics, photography, basic law, Chinese calligraphy, 3-D printing, local history, cooking, debate, and more. Some parents are excited. Others are worried. **Should middle schools really let students choose part of their own classes — or should every lesson be decided by teachers?** I believe student-chosen electives are not just a nice idea; they are a small but important step forward.

② First, chosen classes **wake up motivation**. A required class, however well taught, is a class the student has not asked for. But when a boy has chosen robotics himself, he does not need a teacher to push him; he stays ten extra minutes after the bell to finish a wire, because the project is **his**. Studies on teenagers, both in China and abroad, have shown that when students have even a small amount of real choice over what they learn, their attention, their memory, and their happiness all go up.

③ Second, electives help **show what a student is good at**. Many middle-school students still do not know themselves. A girl who always got average marks in maths may suddenly glow in photography class; a boy who hates writing essays may discover that he can write a clear courtroom speech in debate. Without choices, these hidden strengths would never appear, and the student would grow up believing "I am not special", just because school never asked her.

④ Third, the 21st-century world rewards **people who can manage their own learning**. Gone are the days when a worker simply did what the boss told him. Today, doctors keep studying new therapies, programmers learn new languages, factory engineers update themselves every year. A middle-school student who, at thirteen, has already decided between "I will try Chinese calligraphy this term" and "I will try 3-D printing this term" is quietly learning a life skill: **how to choose, and how to be responsible for the choice**.

⑤ Of course, **some people disagree**. The most common worry is that middle-school students are **too young to choose well**. If we let a twelve-year-old pick his own classes, one father said, "he will choose cooking simply because it smells nice." There is some truth here. But the answer is not "take away the choice"; it is **guide the choice**. Schools can require a balance — say, one arts elective, one science elective, one social elective

each year — and parents can talk with their children about the list at the kitchen table. Guided choice is still real choice.

⑥ A second worry is **fairness**. If popular classes like 3-D printing fill up in two minutes, what about the quiet students who check the form later? This is a fair concern. Schools should deal with it honestly: a small lottery for popular electives, a waiting list that rotates each term, and a rule that every elective opens a second section if enough students sign up. Fairness is solved by careful rules, not by cancelling choice.

⑦ A third worry is **academic pressure**. Critics say middle-school students already have so many compulsory subjects — Chinese, maths, English, physics, chemistry, history, geography, PE, music, art — that adding "another class to think about" is simply too much. But electives are **not extra** work; they are **different** work. Four hours of photography or drama replace four hours that used to be a dull self-study period. Many students say electives are in fact the part of the week where they **rest their tired heads** while still learning.

⑧ There is also a deeper reason. A school is not only a factory for exam scores; it is also a place where young people slowly become themselves. A student who has, by the age of fifteen, tried drama, cooked a dish for twenty classmates, sewn a small flag, taken 200 photos and defended an idea in front of a class, has already lived a more varied life than many adults. That variety is not a distraction from education; it **is** education.

⑨ In conclusion, I believe every middle school should offer, in addition to required classes, at least **four hours of truly chosen electives each week**. To keep the system healthy, schools should balance subjects across arts, science and society; make fair rules for popular classes; and invite teachers to open **new** electives each year when students request them. No fourteen-year-old should graduate without having chosen at least one thing to love.

注释： elective 选修；motivation 动力；calligraphy 书法；therapy 疗法；lottery 抽签；compulsory 必修的

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main view in this essay?

A. Middle schools should cancel all required classes.
B. Middle-school students are too young to choose any class, so teachers must decide everything.
C. Middle schools should offer, in addition to required classes, at least four hours of truly chosen electives a week.
D. Every class should be chosen entirely by parents.

2. According to Paragraph 2, why do chosen classes often lead to stronger learning?

A. Because the classes are shorter.
B. Because, when a student has real choice, attention, memory and happiness all go up; the project becomes "his" and motivation rises naturally.
C. Because teachers are stricter in elective classes.
D. Because elective classes give extra free food.

3. What does the writer mean when he says that without elective classes, some students "would grow up believing 'I am not special' just because school never asked her" (Paragraph 3)?

A. A student's true strengths may never be discovered if the school never gives chances outside required subjects.
B. Students are not special in any way.
C. Schools should only care about maths.
D. Parents should never talk to students.

4. How does the writer reply to the worry that "students are too young to choose"?

A. He fully agrees and gives up his view.
B. He says nothing.
C. He proposes guided choice: schools require a balance across subjects and parents talk with the child, so choice is real but wise.
D. He says only 18-year-olds can ever choose anything.

5. Which of the following statements is closest to the writer's overall message?

A. Electives are just extra pressure and should be stopped.
B. Offering students real choice in electives wakes up motivation, reveals strengths, builds life skills and helps them slowly become themselves — so schools should keep and expand them with fair rules.
C. Schools should only teach exam subjects.
D. Only Grade 9 students should have any electives.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第①段 "student-chosen electives ... an important step forward"；第⑨段 "at least four hours of truly chosen electives each week"
【解析】作者支持学校在必修外开设选修。A 极端、B、D 与原文相反。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "when students have even a small amount of real choice ... their attention, their memory, and their happiness all go up"
【解析】自主选择提升投入。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第③段全段对"隐性优势"的描写
【解析】选修给学生发掘天赋的机会。B、C、D 均误读。故选 A。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "the answer is not 'take away the choice'; it is guide the choice ... one arts elective, one science elective, one social elective each year"
【解析】作者提出"引导式选择"作为回应。A 放弃、B、D 均错。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑧⑨段综合总结
【解析】作者积极正面肯定选修班的多重价值并建议配套规则。A、C、D 与原文立场相反。故选 B。